

Gang (Ernest) Pan

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ACADEMIC	The University of Akron	Akron, Ohio
APPOINTMENTS	Assistant Professor in Accounting	2025-present
	Visiting Assistant Professor in Accounting	2024

RESEARCH INTERESTS	I apply neoclassical economic analysis to the study of corporate taxation, the structure and role of capital information intermediaries, the real effects of accounting, the accounting labor market, and firm strategies.
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EDUCATION	Washington University in St. Louis	St. Louis, Missouri
	Ph.D. in Accounting	2024
	Master of Science in Business Administration, Accounting	2023
	University of Texas at Dallas	Richardson, Texas
	Graduate certificate in Accounting	2018
	Xiamen University	Xiamen, China
	Bachelor of Management, Accounting	2017
	Bachelor of Art, English	2017

RESEARCH	[1] The (Limited) Competitive Advantage of Tax Planning <i>Solo-authored</i> http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4817541 • Innovations in corporate tax planning increase excess returns. • This relation reflects competitive advantages from tax planning. • The competitive advantage of tax planning is limited and lacks persistence. [2] Serial Correlation of Analyst Coverage Initiations (<i>Buchan prize winner</i>) <i>with Richard Frankel and Yaping Zheng</i> • The serial correlation of initiations captures the setup cost of following a firm. • The serial correlation varies with accrual quality and GAAP changes. [3] Misapplications of Accounting Rate of Returns in Taxation Literature <i>Solo-authored</i> • Tax planning investments, when immediately expensed, reduce the contemporaneous accounting rate of return. • These investments increase future accounting rates of return but do not indicate any “real effects” of tax planning. [4] Conservatism, Compensation, and Firm Innovation <i>Solo-authored</i> • Conservatism or pay for performance alone cannot effectively induce innovation.
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- Combining conservatism and high bonuses is associated with better innovation.
- My results support Laux and Ray (2020)'s view that more conservatism increases the informativeness of good signals, allowing higher bonuses for high outcomes.

WORK-IN-PROGRESS

[1] Accounting Profession in the Era of Dopamine Indulgence: Evidence from Online Sports Betting Legalization

with Bo Ren

[2] Financial Information Federalism

Solo-authored

[3] Peer Tax Planning Co-movement

with Bright Godigbe

TEACHING

Instructor, School of Accountancy (The University of Akron)

ACCT 321 Financial Reporting and Analysis I FL 2024-present

ACCT 322 Financial Reporting and Analysis II FL 2024-present

Assistant lecturer, Olin Business School (Washington University)

Principles of Managerial Accounting

with Zachary Kaplan FL 2023

Introduction to Financial Accounting (MBA)

with Edwige Cheynel SP/FL 2022, SP 2023

Teaching assistant, Olin Business School (Washington University)

Business Analysis Using Financial Statements

with Jeremy Bertomeu FL 2021

with Kimball Chapman SP/SU 2021

Advanced Business Analysis using Financial Statements

with Jeremy Bertomeu FL 2021

with Kimball Chapman SP/SU 2021

Teaching assistant, School of Management (Xiamen University)

Financial Strategy

with Jianming Ye FL 2018

SERVICE

Academic Service

Ad Hoc Referee, *Business Horizons* 2025

Ad Hoc Referee, AAA Annual Meeting 2024

Ad Hoc Referee, Hawaii Accounting Research Conference 2025

Ad Hoc Referee, Annual American Taxation Association Midyear Meeting 2025

Ad Hoc Referee, Annual Conference of the Accounting and Economics Society 2025

George W. Daverio School of Accountancy, The University of Akron

Research committee member 2024-present

Hiring committee member 2025

Student professional development committee member 2024-present

Olin Business School, Washington University

Ph.D. Student Committee member 2022-2023

Simon Hall Student Seminar organizer 2022-2023

HONORS AND SCHOLARSHIPS	Buchan Prize (Olin Business School, Washington University)	2023
	Doctoral Fellowship (Olin Business School, Washington University)	2019
	Faculty Development Program Endowment (Xiamen University)	2016
	Fuyao Scholarship (Xiamen University; Fuyao Glass Industry Group)	2016
INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE	Ernst & Young , Assurance Department	Beijing, China
	Audit Intern	Spring 2016
	Ernst & Young , HR Department	Xiamen, China
	Campus Recruitment Assistant	2015-2016
PRESENTATION	Washington University	2020-2024
	Tulane University	2024
	The University of Akron	2024, 2026
	Case Western Reserve University	2024, 2026
CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION	Nicholas Dopuch Accounting Research Conference	2019, 2021, 2022, 2023‡, 2024, 2025
	AAA Annual meeting	2023, 2024†, 2025§
	Hawaii Accounting Research Conference	2025†§
	Annual American Taxation Association Midyear Meeting	2025†
	The All-OHIO Accounting Conference	2025, 2026†§
	Fox and Haskayne Accounting Conference	2024
	Annual Ohio State and Local Tax Conference	2024
	WashU Annual Graduate Research Symposium	2024‡
	Accounting and Economics Society Summer Camp	2020, 2022
	Labor and Accounting Group Conference	2022
	CAPANA Research Conference	2018
	AAA New Faculty Consortium	2026
	IAS PhD/New Faculty Consortium	2026
	† denotes presentation; ‡ denotes poster presentation; § denotes discussion.	
SKILLS	Programming	
	TeX, Matlab, Mathematica, Python, SAS, STATA	
	Languages	
	English, Mandarin Chinese	
PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS	American Accounting Association	2023 – Present
	American Taxation Association	2023 – Present
	AAA International Accounting Section	2025 – Present
	Accounting and Economics Society	2024 – Present

Reference

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